



LEARNING JOURNEY - EPISODE 031

Small steps: Stop first, explain second

Watch, notice, practise and transfer the adult move.

Educator worksheet

Episode 031

5 pages



A short staff reflection tool aligned to Episode 031. Use it after viewing the story, or work from the printed moment and next sentence.

Production resource - adapt to the child, setting, culture, access needs and safety context.



01 - WATCH AND NOTICE

What changed - and what stayed?

Begin with observable words and actions. Treat the possible weather as a lens for reflection, not a fact about a child's inner state.



ORIGINAL MOMENT

"STOP!"

POSSIBLE WEATHER

Young children may hear a pressured sentence as a message about who they are. Keep the language short, concrete and close to the next action.

NOTICE

What happened that a camera could record?

POSSIBLE IMPACT

What might the words communicate? Use may, might or could.

KEEP

What expectation, responsibility, safety or learning need remains?

CHANGE

Which part of the delivery could become more specific or usable?

Episode principle

Distinguish a necessary safety voice from shaming or prolonged anger.



02 - BUILD THE NEXT SENTENCE

Practise the move in four parts.

These parts are a rehearsal scaffold, not a formula that must be spoken word-for-word.

1

Pause

Identify what the moment requires before adding more words.

"Distinguish a necessary safety voice from shaming or prolonged anger."

2

Describe

Use specific, observable information instead of a broad judgement.

"STOP!"

3

Keep

Retain the boundary, responsibility, safety or learning need.

"Move to safety before giving the explanation."

4

Next

Offer the clearest usable sentence or action from the short.

"Immediate danger must stop now. First, move to safety before giving the explanation."

YOUR NEXT SENTENCE

Write a version that sounds natural in your setting.

Try it aloud

Check pace, volume and number of directions. If it becomes a lecture, shorten it to the first useful action.



03 - TRANSFER TO PRACTICE

Use the move beyond this one story.

Choose low-stakes examples for adult practice. Do not invite children or colleagues to disclose family conflict, harm or private experiences.

SCENE 1

Same setting

Rehearse another immediate safety moment where the adult needs to move to safety before giving the explanation.



SCENE 2

A busier moment

Shorten the language while keeping the boundary, safety need or learning expectation.



SCENE 3

When it repeats

Identify what adjustment, information or support may be needed beyond one sentence.



STAFF DISCUSSION

Where might this pressure enter adult language? What specific wording could make the next action clearer?

ADAPTATION

How could the move be made accessible for language, motor, sensory, cultural or communication needs?



04 - REVIEW BEFORE USE

A safe discussion has clear limits.

This sample is for adult reflection. It is not a behaviour plan, assessment tool or substitute for school, service or safeguarding procedures.

FACILITATOR CHECK

- ☐ We use possibility language for possible child experience.
- ☐ We retain the boundary, consequence or safety instruction.
- ☐ We adapt the response to age, ability, context and hazard.
- ☐ We do not invite public disclosure of private experiences.
- ☐ We follow local safeguarding and incident procedures.
- ☐ We offer a private or opt-out response route.



Episode safety note

Use local safeguarding and incident procedures. Persistent distress, online harm or safety concerns need context-specific support.

DRAFT ALIGNMENT NOTES

Possible connections: Australian Curriculum v9.0 - Personal and Social capability: Self-management; Australian Curriculum v9.0 HPE - Making healthy and safe choices; EYLF V2.0 - Outcome 3: Wellbeing and safety

Select only the framework elements actually addressed in local learning. Alignment does not mean government approval, curriculum mandate or endorsement.

Release status: educator, parent, safeguarding, accessibility and claims review completed for template use; local contextual review remains required.

Scope

General educational information for adults. Persistent distress, safety concerns or marked changes in wellbeing need context-specific support.